



*Heron always swallow fish headfirst,
so the fins don't stick in their throat.*

Is that a bird? Or an umbrella? You can see why people call the black heron the “umbrella bird”! When fishing, it stretches its wings over its head and disappears under the feathery canopy. This might make it easier to spot fish underwater, or possibly the heron is making a patch of cool shade that attracts unlucky fish wanting to escape the hot sun.

Heron are excellent fishers. The green heron has its own neat trick. Like humans who go fishing, it uses bait. It drops a small object on the water, such as a stick, nut, feather, or insect, and fish come to the surface for a closer look. Then... snap! The heron swallows its meal down in one.